

Website Project Proposal

Proposal 2 (Retail Store): Kaya Home & Living

1. Organisation Overview

Name: Kaya Home & Living

History: Kaya Home & Living opened as a single storefront in 2018, selling locally made homeware, textiles, and decor pieces sourced from small South African artisans and suppliers. The store has since become a well-regarded destination for handcrafted home goods, but has grown almost entirely through foot traffic and word of mouth. The owner now wants to reach customers beyond the immediate area and offer online purchasing.

Mission: To make beautifully made, locally sourced home decor accessible to a wider audience while supporting South African artisans and small-batch producers.

Vision: To become a leading online and in-store destination for locally made home goods in South Africa.

Target audience: Primarily homeowners and renters aged 25–55 with an interest in interior decor, sustainability, and supporting local makers; secondary audience of gift-shoppers looking for unique, locally made items.

2. Website Goals and Objectives

Goals

- Launch a functional online store to sell products beyond the physical shop's local catchment area.
- Increase overall revenue by opening a new, low-overhead sales channel.
- Build an email list for repeat marketing and seasonal promotions.
- Showcase the story behind each product/artisan to differentiate from mass-market retailers.
- Provide store location, hours, and stock information for in-store shoppers.

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

- Online sales revenue (target: 20% of total monthly revenue within 12 months of launch).
- Conversion rate on product pages (target: 2–3%, in line with e-commerce benchmarks).
- Cart abandonment rate below 65%.
- Email newsletter sign-ups (target: 300 within the first 6 months).
- Average order value (tracked monthly to inform bundling/upsell strategy).

3. Current Website Analysis

Kaya Home & Living currently has only a basic Instagram business profile and a single-page Google Business listing; there is no dedicated website or e-commerce capability.

Strengths of current online presence

Strong, visually appealing product photography already exists on Instagram.
Engaged local following built up over several years.

Weaknesses

No way to purchase products online — all sales require an in-person visit.
No searchable product catalogue, pricing, or stock information available digitally.
Instagram algorithm limits organic reach; the business has no owned channel independent of the platform.
No email capture, so there is no direct way to re-engage past customers.

Areas for improvement

Introduce a proper e-commerce storefront with secure checkout.
Create a searchable, categorised product catalogue with clear pricing and stock status.
Add email capture and a lightweight loyalty/promotions programme.

4. Proposed Website Features and Functionality

Home page: Featured/new-in products, seasonal promotions banner, and brand story snapshot.
Shop page: Filterable, categorised product catalogue (e.g. by room, material, price) with search functionality.

Product detail pages: High-quality images, description, price, stock status, artisan/maker story, and related products.

Cart & Checkout: Secure cart, guest checkout option, multiple payment methods (card, EFT, Snapscan), and delivery/collection options.

About Us page: Store history, artisan partnerships, and sustainability commitments.

Store Locator/Visit Us page: Address, trading hours, embedded map, and in-store-only promotions.

Account/Order Tracking: Customer login, order history, and shipment tracking.

Blog/Journal: Styling tips, artisan spotlights, and seasonal decor guides to support SEO and repeat visits.

5. Design and User Experience

Branding and Aesthetic

Colour Scheme: A warm, earthy palette reflecting natural materials as the primary accent, deep charcoal for text and structure, and soft linen/sand backgrounds to let product photography stand out.

Typography: An elegant serif for headings to convey craftsmanship and quality, paired with a clean sans-serif for body text and product details for easy scanning while shopping.

Layout and Design: A visually driven, grid-based layout with large product photography, generous white space, and minimal on-page clutter, consistent with premium home-decor retail sites.

User Experience Considerations

Persistent, easy-to-find cart icon and simplified checkout flow (target: 3 steps or fewer) to reduce abandonment.

Prominent filtering and search on the Shop page so customers can narrow large catalogues quickly.

Mobile-optimised product galleries with pinch-to-zoom, since a large share of decor shopping happens on mobile.

Clear stock and delivery-time indicators on every product page to manage customer expectations.

Low-Fidelity Wireframe — Shop Page Structure

Header: Logo | Navigation | Search | Cart icon

Left sidebar (desktop) / collapsible filter drawer (mobile): category, price, material filters

Main grid: product thumbnail, name, price, quick-add-to-cart

Pagination or infinite scroll at bottom of grid

Footer: newsletter sign-up, store info, social links, payment icons

6. Technical Requirements

Hosting: E-commerce-capable hosting with sufficient bandwidth and storage for product images (e.g. a managed WooCommerce or Shopify hosting plan).

Domain name: www.kayahomeandliving.co.za

Languages/Frameworks: HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript for the front end; WooCommerce (on WordPress) or Shopify as the e-commerce platform to handle catalogue, cart, and checkout; PHP (if WooCommerce) for custom functionality; integration with a South African payment gateway (PayFast, Yoco, or Snapscan) and a courier/delivery API for shipping quotes.

7. Timeline and Milestones

Milestone	Deliverable	Target Week
Discovery & planning	Finalised proposal, sitemap, product taxonomy	Week 1–2
Design	Visual mock-ups, colour/typography finalised	Week 3–4
Development – catalogue	Shop, product detail, and category pages built	Week 5–7
Development – e-commerce	Cart, checkout, payment gateway integrated	Week 8–9
Testing & QA	Payment testing, cross-browser and mobile testing	Week 10
Launch	Site goes live, DNS and SSL configured	Week 11
Review	Post-launch analytics review and handover	Week 12

8. Budget

Item	Description	Estimated Cost (ZAR)
Domain registration	.co.za domain, annual	R150 / year
Hosting	E-commerce-ready hosting plan, annual	R3,600 / year
E-commerce platform	WooCommerce (free) + premium theme, once-off	R2,000
Payment gateway setup	PayFast/Yoco integration & transaction fees	R0 setup + 2.9–3.5% per transaction
Development time	Design, build, and testing (freelance/student rate)	R14,000
Product photography	Professional photography for catalogue	R3,000
Contingency	10% buffer for unforeseen costs	R2,275
Total (Year 1)		≈ R25,025

9. References

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